



Eye Drops Vs. Ear Drops

Medication Errors

Prevent wrong administration of medical Drops

Pharmacist's Letter: Help Ensure Ear Meds aren't for the eye.

Agenda:



PREVENTING EAR DROPS FROM
BEING INSTILLED INTO THE EYES.



WATCH FOR DANGEROUS
ABBREVIATIONS.



SEPARATE STORAGE AREAS.



COUNSEL PATIENTS TO HELP
REINFORCE PROPER USE.

Background:

As we all knows (Hopefully LOL) that Eye drops can be use for Ears for same kind of purpose like infections or dryness, but we **CANNOT** instill Ear drops into the Eyes, because of the ear drops are usually acidic and may not be sterile enough to instill into the eye. When a practitioner, patient, or caregiver accidentally instills ear drops into the eye, it may lead to an immediate burning and/or stinging sensation, and the patient may later experience pain, redness, swelling, or blurred vision.

Medications Names

Can you
guess
which one
is an Eye
drops or
Ear drops?

Ciprofloxacin



Tobramycin



Neomycin/Polymyxin/ Hydrocortisone



Dorzolamide



Ofloxacin

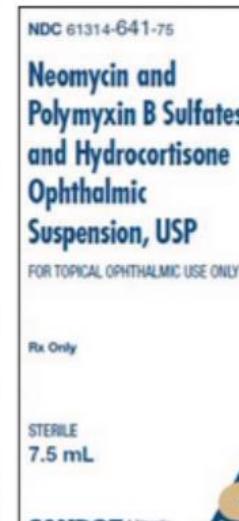
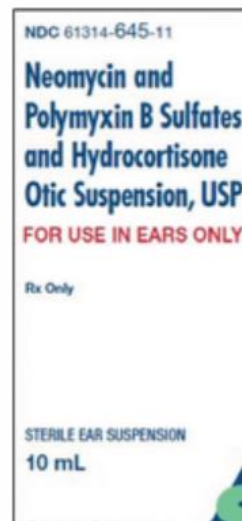


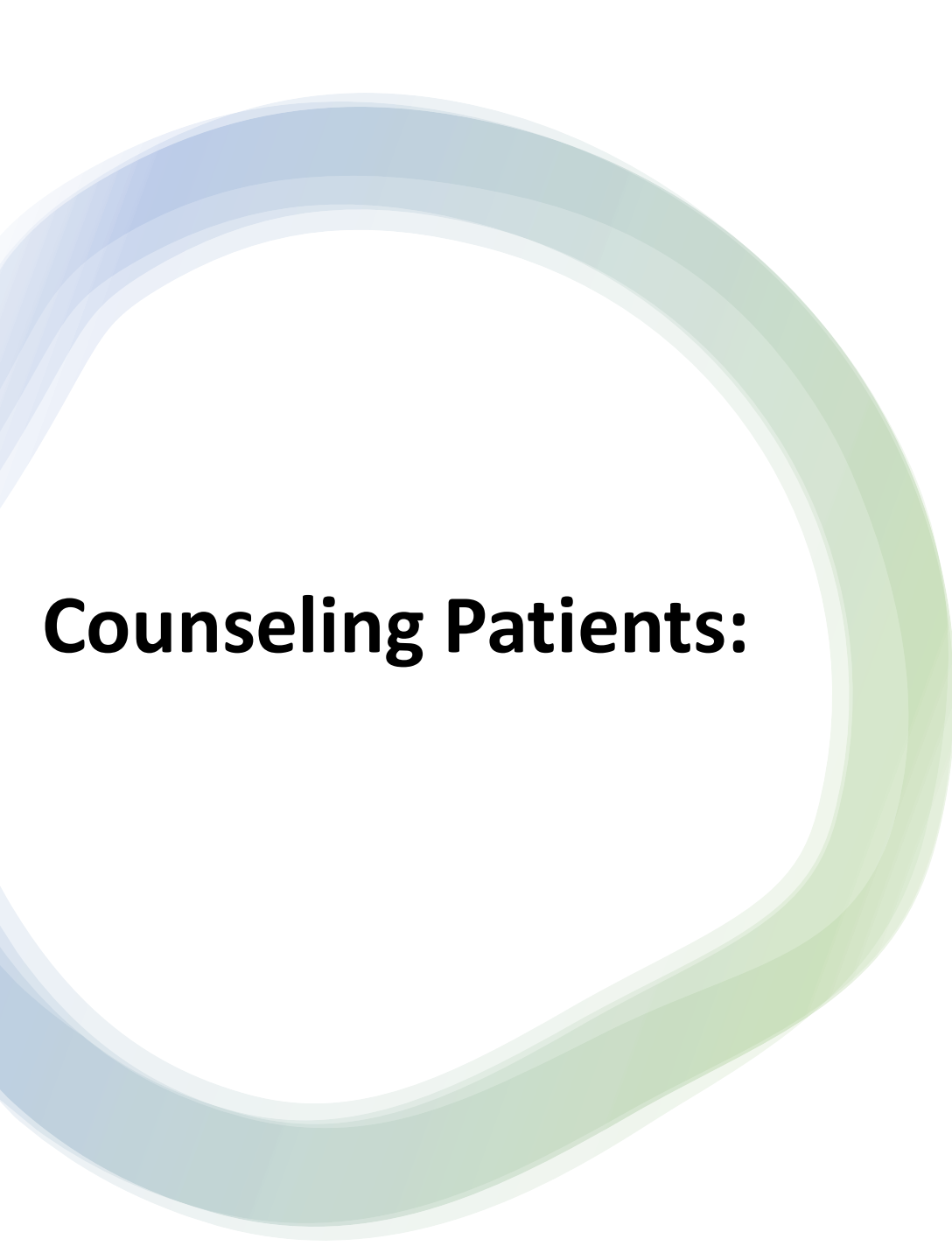
Prednisone



Look alike Sound alike:

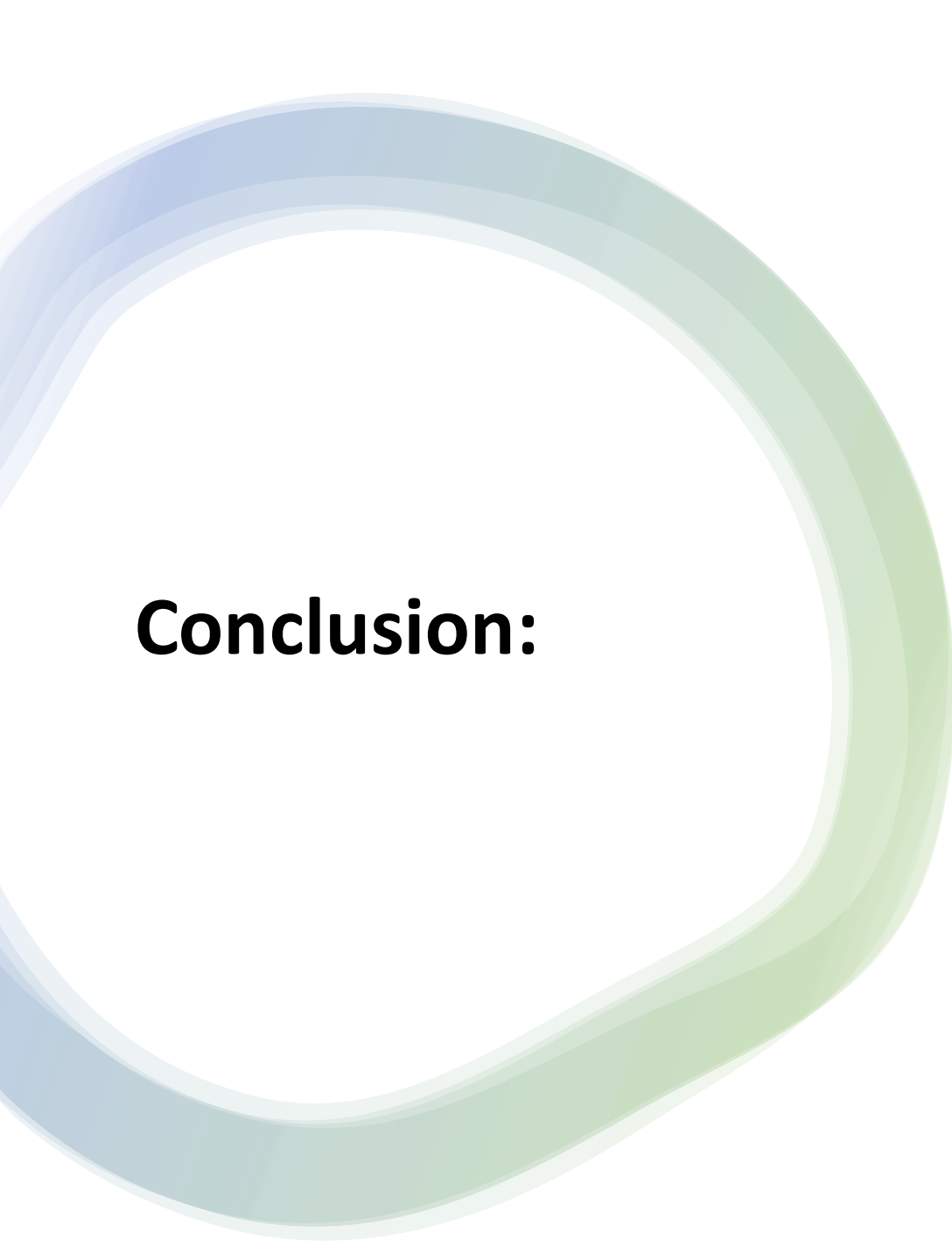
- Aside from look-alike eye and ear medication names and containers, another reported reason for this type of error is confusion between the words “optic” and “otic.”
- Separate the storage areas for ear and eye drop bottles on pharmacy shelves and in automated dispensing cabinets (ADCs).
- Specify the route of administration (e.g., right eye, left eye, each eye) and never use the abbreviations OD, OS, or OU, which can be mistaken as AD, AS, or AU (e.g., right ear, left ear, each ear).
- Restrict prescribers from ordering ear drops for the “eye.”





Counseling Patients:

- Confirm the expected route with the patient. Counsel patients using the teach-back method to reinforce the route. Educate patients to keep ear and eye drops in the carton, store them in separate locations at home, and discard any leftover medication
- When possible, administer ear drops and eye drops on different schedules
- Consider placing an auxiliary label with a photo of an ear or eye on the dropper bottle to specify “ear” or “eye” drops.
- If patients report accidentally using ear meds in the eyes, advise immediately flushing their eyes with water and contacting poison control @ 1-800-222-1222 or seek medical care.



Conclusion:

We encourage manufacturers to consider strategies to reduce the risk of ear versus eye wrong route errors, including differentiating the container (e.g., bottle with a long neck for otic formulations), packaging, and labeling, and adding prominent standard text (e.g. “For use in ears only”) to the respective carton and container labels. Also add standard graphics that visually depict the ear or eye to the carton and/or container labels.